

# The One-Workflow Handoff Checklist

Take a week off and the work waits for you. Not because the team cannot do it. Because the steps, the exceptions, and the judgment calls live in your head. This sheet moves one of them out.

One workflow. About a week. A forty-page manual is not the goal; a handoff that holds is.

PART 1

## Pick the right workflow

Write down three candidates and run each through the five questions. The first handoff needs five yeses. The hardest thing in the business is the wrong place to start.

| QUESTION                                                                   | WORKFLOW 1 | WORKFLOW 2 | WORKFLOW 3 |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|------------|------------|
| It recurs on a schedule, at least monthly.                                 |            |            |            |
| It works today when you run it.                                            |            |            |            |
| One person, you, runs it end to end.                                       |            |            |            |
| You can describe what done looks like, and show a recent accepted example. |            |            |            |
| A specific person could own it, and would want to.                         |            |            |            |

THE WORKFLOW · THE OPERATOR · THE NEXT SCHEDULED RUN

PART 2

## Watch one run and catch the hidden parts

Run it as you normally would, with the sheet next to you. Every time you reach for something, check something, or decide something, write a line. The last two columns are the pages most owners have never written.

| STEP | WHERE THE INPUT<br>REALLY COMES FROM | WHAT I CHECK<br>BEFORE MOVING ON | DECISION HERE,<br>AND WHAT I WEIGH | WHEN IT IS<br>WRONG, I DO |
|------|--------------------------------------|----------------------------------|------------------------------------|---------------------------|
|      |                                      |                                  |                                    |                           |
|      |                                      |                                  |                                    |                           |
|      |                                      |                                  |                                    |                           |
|      |                                      |                                  |                                    |                           |

| STEP | WHERE THE INPUT<br>REALLY COMES FROM | WHAT I CHECK<br>BEFORE MOVING ON | DECISION HERE,<br>AND WHAT I WEIGH | WHEN IT IS<br>WRONG, I DO |
|------|--------------------------------------|----------------------------------|------------------------------------|---------------------------|
|      |                                      |                                  |                                    |                           |
|      |                                      |                                  |                                    |                           |
|      |                                      |                                  |                                    |                           |
|      |                                      |                                  |                                    |                           |

The skip list: steps you skipped this run and why. \_\_\_\_\_

## PART 3

### The short operating guide

One page, written from Part 2. If it needs more than a page, you have two workflows; split them and hand off one. Order matters: the operator reads top to bottom while doing the work.

|                                                     |                                                                  |
|-----------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|
| WHAT THIS IS FOR, AND WHAT DONE LOOKS LIKE<br><hr/> | DECISIONS, EACH WITH THE RULE OF THUMB YOU ACTUALLY USE<br><hr/> |
| INPUTS AND WHERE EACH ONE LIVES<br><hr/>            | EXCEPTIONS, AND WHO TO ASK WHEN ONE SHOWS UP<br><hr/>            |
| STEPS IN ORDER, EACH WITH ITS CHECK<br><hr/> <hr/>  | ONE WORKED EXAMPLE, REAL AND RECENT<br><hr/>                     |

## PART 4

### The cold handoff test

1. **Give the operator the guide and one fresh example.** Not the example you wrote from. A new one that arrived this week.
2. **Be actually unavailable for the run.** A meeting, a day off, a phone in a drawer. Available-if-needed is not the test.
3. **They finish. You review against done.** Compare the output with the accepted example from Part 1, not with how you would have done it.
4. **Score it, then fix the guide, not the person.** Every question they had to ask, and every place the output missed, becomes a line in the guide. Retest on the next run.

#### RESULT

☐ Held: finished without asking, output accepted. ☐ Held with one question: add the line, retest. ☐ Did not hold: the guide is missing a decision rule, usually in Part 3,

column right.

The written guide is also what lets an AI assistant help the operator later: it can read the steps, the checks, and the rules of thumb and answer the operator's questions with a source. Most owners find the guide alone removed the interruptions.